

War Sends More Tremors Through a Shaken World Economy



ALTAF QADRI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Iran, which attacked an Emirati oil facility, above, is still blocking the Strait of Hormuz despite a U.S. raid on a critical oil hub.

PENTAGON MEMO

Hegseth's Vengeful Rhetoric Grew From Experience in Iraq

By GREG JAFFE
WASHINGTON — Long before President Trump chose him to lead the U.S. military, Pete Hegseth described the moral calling that had compelled him to volunteer to serve in Iraq. He was working on Wall Street in the summer of 2005 and had read an article about an insurgent who blew himself up, killing 18 Iraqi children. “To me, that

was the face of evil,” Mr. Hegseth told The Princeton Alumni Weekly, adding, “That sent to me a signal that I need to do my part not to let that ideology win in Iraq.” He deployed to the war-torn city of Samarra a short time later. Today, Mr. Hegseth describes the mission and moral purpose animating the war in Iran, now in its third week, in starkly differ-

ent terms. The goal, he said recently, is to unleash “death and destruction from the sky all day long.” Instead of seeking justice, U.S. forces are pursuing vengeance against an implacable foe. “Their war on Americans has become our retribution,” he vowed. For decades, presidents and their secretaries of defense have framed American military interventions in altruistic terms. Even

though the truth was often more complicated, they cast U.S. troops as liberators bringing democracy and freedom to those living under tyranny and oppression. Mr. Hegseth has largely dispensed with that talk. His bellicose, at times vengeful, rhetoric reflects his belief that the United States’ lofty goals in Iraq and Afghanistan caused the military

Continued on Page 9

At Synagogue, Race to Shield Young Targets

By JULIE BOSMAN and KATHERINE ROSMAN
The bang that shattered the afternoon on Thursday at Temple Israel in West Bloomfield, Mich., was so loud, so inexplicable, that several rabbis and staff members in the building rushed into the hallway all at once. A truck had rammed through the building doors and down a corridor, past the nursery where infants slept, veering toward the gym where children played. Debris was falling from the ceiling and crumpled walls. Rabbi Arianna Gordon saw an overturned stroller surrounded by broken glass and a security guard rushing by with his weapon drawn. Then the sound of gunfire ricocheted through the building, reaching the administrative offices and classrooms, and the ears of dozens of children enrolled in the preschool. The truck became engulfed in flames, filling the halls and offices with smoke. “We needed to get away and get

Continued on Page 19

NETHERLANDS BLASTS No one was hurt in explosions at a Jewish school and a synagogue. PAGE 13



PHOTOGRAPHS BY GABRIELA BHASKAR/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Death Valley in Full Bloom

People have been flocking to see the bonanza of wildflowers that has transformed the hottest, driest place in North America. It has been called the most abundant bloom in a decade. Page 14.

10 Men With Weapons Set Out for Cuba by Boat. What Were They Trying to Do?

By PATRICIA MAZZEI and DAVID C. ADAMS
MIAMI — Before Héctor Cruz Correa left his home in South Florida for an ill-fated boat trip to Cuba last month, he told his mother that he was going fishing. He asked her to make his favorite beef soup for the trip. Another man, Roberto Álvarez Ávila, a father of three, told his

wife that he would see her after his shift as a Walmart security guard. A third, Conrado Galindo Sariol, who had spent eight years in a Cuban prison, told his wife he was going to work delivering packages. None of them returned home. The three men were among 10 Cuban immigrants who, according to the Cuban government, stowed a stockpile of weapons on

two boats in the Florida Keys, set sail and wound up in an armed confrontation with the Cuban coast guard about a mile off the island’s northern coast. The government called it a foiled terrorist attack. Four of the men, including Mr. Cruz Correa, died in the firefight on Feb. 25. Mr. Álvarez, who had been shot, died nine days later. The five others were all injured

How Bezos Upended The Post With a Strategy Fit for Amazon

This article is by **Benjamin Mullin, Erik Wemple and Katie Robertson.** Jeff Bezos called Matt Murray, the executive editor of The Washington Post, in late November to send an urgent message: Please do not quit. Mr. Murray had known for weeks that Mr. Bezos, the billionaire founder of Amazon and owner of The Post, was planning widespread layoffs to stem over \$100 million in annual losses. But Mr. Murray felt sidelined in the preparations and had recently told the company’s chief executive, Will Lewis, that he was leaving the paper, according to two

people with knowledge of the discussions. Mr. Bezos told Mr. Murray that he wanted him to help shape a newsroom that would be financially sustainable far into the future, the two people said. And Mr. Bezos pitched his strategy: Reduce the newsroom’s budget by half and double the productivity of those who remained, all while protecting some core parts of The Post’s coverage, like investigative journalism. Mr. Murray said he would take on that challenge. In a single call, Mr. Bezos had set a new course for The Post and upended the power balance between his top news editor, Mr.

Continued on Page 16

NATIONAL 14-22

Lives of 2 Soldiers Diverged
Lt. Col. Brandon Shah flew hundreds of combat missions before being killed in his Old Dominion University classroom by a radicalized veteran. PAGE 18

ARTS & LEISURE

Who Wasn't Right for a Role?
A new Oscar will recognize excellence in casting a movie. Yet it can be fun to look at past mismatches. We've made a list of some of our favorites. PAGE 8

SUNDAY STYLES

Captivating Complexions
The makeup artist Nina Park has built a long and impressive client list by helping celebrities “really look like themselves.” PAGE 1

SUNDAY BUSINESS

Wealthy, but Less Charitable
It was once trendy among the world's billionaires to sign the Giving Pledge, but the project has fallen on hard times as a philanthropic dream dims. PAGE 6

SUNDAY OPINION

Michelle Goldberg PAGE 6

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